8. Decomposition is the process of breaking of complex organic matter into simpler inorganic matter. There are five steps of decomposition. These are fragmentation, leaching, catabolism, humification and mineralization. Fragmentation is the process of breaking of detritus into small pieces by detrivores such as earthworm. Leaching is the process of releasing nutrients in the water and seeping into the soil. Catabolism is the process of breaking down of complex molecules into the simpler molecules. Humification is the process of formation of dark coloured substance humus on the soil. It undergoes microbial action at a slow rate. Mineraland is the process of degradation of the humnus to release inorganic nutrients.

   Thus, the correct answer is 'Fragmentation.'

9. Except commensalism, all other are negative biotic interactions.
   - Amensalism: One species is inhibited while the other species is unaffected.
   - Predation: One species (predator) benefits while the second species (prey) is harmed and inhibited.
   - Parasitism: Beneficial to one species (parasite) and harmful to the other species (host).
   - Commensalism: One species (the commensal) benefits, while the other species (the host) is neither harmed nor inhibited.

10. In aquatic ecosystems, the pyramid of biomass may assume an inverted form. In contrast, a pyramid of numbers for the aquatic ecosystem is upright.

    An energy pyramid represents the amount of energy at each trophic level and loss of energy at each transfer to another trophic level. Hence the pyramid is always upward, with a large energy base at the bottom.